

Verified

# UEFA European Championship

The European Championship began in 1960 as the European Nations' Cup. Early final tournaments had only four teams. The modern EURO expanded to eight teams in 1980, sixteen in 1996, and twenty-four in 2016.

## UEFA European Championship editions, 1960 onward

| Year        | Host(s) | Teams | Winner       | Runner-up | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                |
|-------------|---------|-------|--------------|-----------|--------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| <u>2024</u> | Germany | 24    | <u>Spain</u> | England   | France             | Netherlands                 | Spain 2-1<br>England |

| Year        | Host(s)                | Teams | Winner          | Runner-up | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                   |
|-------------|------------------------|-------|-----------------|-----------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------|
| <u>2020</u> | Eleven European cities | 24    | <u>Italy</u>    | England   | Spain              | Denmark                     | 1-1; Italy pens         |
| <u>2016</u> | France                 | 24    | <u>Portugal</u> | France    | Germany            | Wales                       | Portugal 1<br>France (a |

| Year        | Host(s)                 | Teams | Winner       | Runner-up | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                |
|-------------|-------------------------|-------|--------------|-----------|--------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|
| <u>2012</u> | Poland and Ukraine      | 16    | <u>Spain</u> | Italy     | Germany            | Portugal                    | Spain 4-0            |
| <u>2008</u> | Austria and Switzerland | 16    | <u>Spain</u> | Germany   | Russia             | Türkiye                     | Spain 1-0<br>Germany |

| Year        | Host(s)                       | Teams | Winner         | Runner-up         | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                              |
|-------------|-------------------------------|-------|----------------|-------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <u>2004</u> | Portugal                      | 16    | <u>Greece</u>  | Portugal          | Czech Republic     | Netherlands                 | Greece 1-<br>Portugal              |
| <u>2000</u> | Belgium<br>and<br>Netherlands | 16    | <u>France</u>  | Italy             | Portugal           | Netherlands                 | France 2-<br>Italy (gold<br>goal)  |
| <u>1996</u> | England                       | 16    | <u>Germany</u> | Czech<br>Republic | England            | France                      | Germany<br>Czech Rep<br>(golden go |

| Year        | Host(s)      | Teams | Winner              | Runner-up    | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                           |
|-------------|--------------|-------|---------------------|--------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <u>1992</u> | Sweden       | 8     | <u>Denmark</u>      | Germany      | Netherlands        | Sweden                      | Denmark 1-0<br>Germany          |
| <u>1988</u> | West Germany | 8     | <u>Netherlands</u>  | Soviet Union | West Germany       | Italy                       | Netherlands 2-0<br>Soviet Union |
| <u>1984</u> | France       | 8     | <u>France</u>       | Spain        | Portugal           | Denmark                     | France 2-0<br>Spain             |
| <u>1980</u> | Italy        | 8     | <u>West Germany</u> | Belgium      | Czechoslovakia     | Italy                       | West Germany 2-1<br>Belgium     |

| Year        | Host(s)    | Teams | Winner                | Runner-up    | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                               |
|-------------|------------|-------|-----------------------|--------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <u>1976</u> | Yugoslavia | 4     | <u>Czechoslovakia</u> | West Germany | Netherlands        | Yugoslavia                  | 2-2;<br>Czechoslo<br>5-3 pens       |
| <u>1972</u> | Belgium    | 4     | <u>West Germany</u>   | Soviet Union | Belgium            | Hungary                     | West Gern<br>3-0 Soviet Union       |
| <u>1968</u> | Italy      | 4     | <u>Italy</u>          | Yugoslavia   | England            | Soviet Union                | Italy 2-0<br>Yugoslavia<br>(replay) |
| <u>1964</u> | Spain      | 4     | <u>Spain</u>          | Soviet Union | Hungary            | Denmark                     | Spain 2-1<br>Soviet Uni             |

| Year        | Host(s) | Teams | Winner              | Runner-up  | Other semifinalist | Other semifinalist / fourth | Final                               |
|-------------|---------|-------|---------------------|------------|--------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <u>1960</u> | France  | 4     | <u>Soviet Union</u> | Yugoslavia | Czechoslovakia     | France                      | Soviet Uni<br>2-1 Yugos<br>(a.e.t.) |

## Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

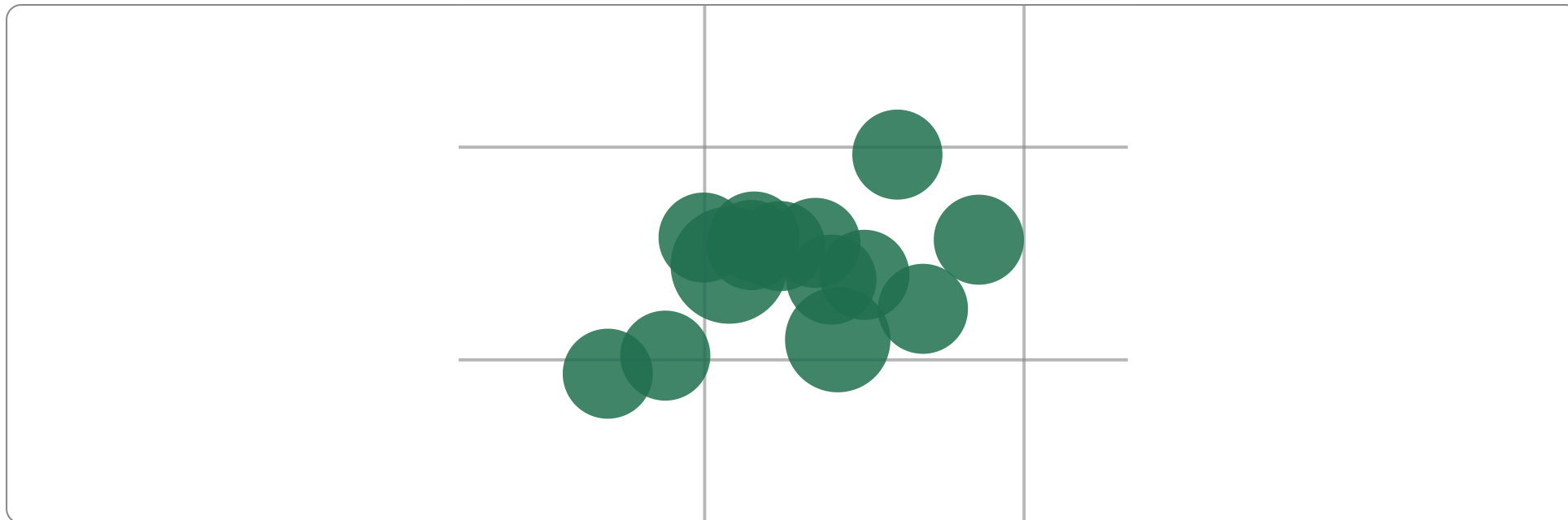
|                                                                        |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Spain</b><br><div></div><br>1964, 2008, 2012, 2024                  | <b>4</b> |
| <b>Germany (incl. West Germany)</b><br><div></div><br>1972, 1980, 1996 | <b>3</b> |
| <b>Italy</b><br><div></div><br>1968, 2020                              | <b>2</b> |

|                                                                                                                    |          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>France</b><br><br>1984, 2000   | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Soviet Union</b><br><br>1960   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Czechoslovakia</b><br><br>1976 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Netherlands</b><br><br>1988    | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Denmark</b><br><br>1992        | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Greece</b><br><br>2004         | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Portugal</b><br><br>2016     | <b>1</b> |

**Where the tournament has been hosted**

Every host country's approximate location on a simple latitude/longitude grid, grouped by region in the list below - not a claim of exact borders, just roughly where in the world each edition took place. Bigger dots hosted more than once.





## Europe

**France** 3 times

1960, 1984, 2016

**Spain** 1 time

1964

**Italy** 2 times

1968, 1980

**Belgium** 1 time

1972

**Yugoslavia** 1 time

1976

**West Germany** 1 time

1988

**Sweden** 1 time

1992

**England** 1 time

1996

**Belgium and Netherlands** 1

time

2000

**Portugal** 1 time

2004

**Austria and Switzerland** 1

time

2008

**Poland and Ukraine** 1 time

2012

**Eleven European cities** 1

time

2020

**Germany** 1 time

2024

## **How it works**

- UEFA national teams qualify over roughly two years of group matches before the finals.
- The finals open with a group stage; the best-placed teams in each group move on.
- From the quarterfinals onward it is a straight knockout: a single loss ends a team's tournament.
- The final decides the champion; no third-place match has been played since 1980 (see "Historical format note" below).

## **Historical format note**

A third-place match was played through 1980. From 1984 onward, UEFA recognizes both defeated semifinalists without ranking them third and fourth. The table therefore uses neutral “other semifinalist” wording.

### **Player of the Tournament winners**

- UEFA has named a best-player award at every EURO since 1996; no equivalent award existed at the four earlier editions.
- **1996:** Matthias Sammer (Germany).
- **2000:** Zinedine Zidane (France).
- **2004:** Theodoros Zagorakis (Greece) - captain of the surprise 2004 champions.
- **2008:** Xavi Hernández (Spain).
- **2012:** Andrés Iniesta (Spain).
- **2016:** Antoine Griezmann (France) - runner-up with France, the only winner of the award not to lift the trophy that year.
- **2020:** Gianluigi Donnarumma (Italy) - the first goalkeeper to win the award.
- **2024:** Rodri (Spain).

### **Young Player of the Tournament winners**

- UEFA has named a best-player-aged-21-or-under award at every EURO since 2016; no equivalent award existed at earlier editions.
- **2016:** Renato Sanches (Portugal).
- **2020:** Pedri (Spain).
- **2024:** Lamine Yamal (Spain).

### **Memorable moments**

- Antonín Panenka's famous chipped penalty decided the 1976 shoot-out.
- Denmark entered the 1992 tournament late and went on to win it.
- Greece produced one of international football's greatest surprises in 2004.
- Spain became the first nation to retain the EURO title in 2012.

- The delayed EURO 2020 was played in 2021 across multiple countries.
- Spain won a record fourth title in 2024.

## References & review

Status: verified

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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.